01 / INTERACTION CONTRACT

Define the interaction's observable promise.

CONTRACT ROW

draft + review → review

MODEL BOUNDARY

4 states, 6 unique transitions; undefined pairs are rejected. Not implemented.



Figure 1 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

This specification describes a fictional local note editor with draft, review, saved and error states. Its purpose is to make allowed transitions inspectable before implementation.

The contract models six transitions for one note. It does not implement storage, authentication, collaboration or a live service. A model passing its own checks is not evidence that a product behaves correctly.

Interaction goal

Review means a chance to inspect a note before a save attempt. Saved is a modeled outcome that an implementation must justify with a real storage result.

STATE / EVENT / NEXT STATE

Object	Contract	Non-goal
One fictional note, with text and an immutable source reference.	Four named states and six explicit event transitions.	No live persistence or production capability is claimed.

What must a reader be able to predict?

02 / INTERACTION CONTRACT

Separate the actor from the authority.

CONTRACT ROW

review + edit → draft

MODEL BOUNDARY

4 states, 6 unique transitions; undefined pairs are rejected. Not implemented.



Figure 1 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

The modeled actor can edit the note body, review it and request a local save. The source reference is not editable through this contract and does not imply rights to the source.

There are no administrator, reviewer or shared-workspace roles. The state named review refers to the author's own inspection, not another person's approval or a permission workflow.

Actor boundary

A disabled action is not an access-control boundary. Any future real service would need its own authorization and data-handling design.

STATE / EVENT / NEXT STATE

Actor

A hypothetical single author in a local editing context.

Editable

Note text, not source ownership or sharing permissions.

Excluded

No reviewer assignment, access grant or account role exists.

Which actions are within this actor's remit?

03 / INTERACTION CONTRACT

Give each object a stable meaning.

CONTRACT ROW

review + save-ok → saved

MODEL BOUNDARY

4 states, 6 unique transitions; undefined pairs are rejected. Not implemented.



Figure 2 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

The note body is a string; its source reference identifies the invented exercise passage. The model's state is separate from the note text and must not be inferred from styling alone.

The event vocabulary is review, edit, save-ok, save-fail and retry. These events have meaning only with their defined source state. An unspecified state-event pair is rejected by the contract.

Object dictionary

A real implementation should distinguish the user's save request from the asynchronous result. Here save-ok and save-fail name result events, not clickable product controls.

STATE / EVENT / NEXT STATE

Text

The authored note body being revised.

Source

A stable reference outside the editable body.

Events

Review, edit, save-ok, save-fail and retry are model tokens.

Can a label be mistaken for a stored result?

04 / INTERACTION CONTRACT

Make the four states mutually exclusive.

CONTRACT ROW

review + save-fail → error

MODEL BOUNDARY

4 states, 6 unique transitions; undefined pairs are rejected. Not implemented.



Figure 2 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

Draft permits text editing. Review presents the current text for inspection. Saved represents a successful modeled save result. Error represents a failed modeled save result and preserves the text.

Exactly one state is active for one modeled note. The specification has no background saving or concurrent session. Those omissions must be revisited rather than hidden behind an ambiguous loading indicator.

State inventory

State labels should remain understandable without color. This is a design requirement to review, not a tested accessibility outcome.

STATE / EVENT / NEXT STATE

Draft

Editable text before a review decision.

Review

Inspect the current text before a save result.

Saved / error

Distinct result states; neither silently changes the note.

Can the current state be explained without the visual treatment?

05 / INTERACTION CONTRACT

List transitions rather than implying them.

CONTRACT ROW

error + retry → review

MODEL BOUNDARY

4 states, 6 unique transitions; undefined pairs are rejected. Not implemented.



Figure 3 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

Draft plus review enters review. Review plus edit returns to draft. Review plus save-ok enters saved, while review plus save-fail enters error. Error plus retry returns to review; saved plus edit returns to draft.

These six rows form the complete modeled transition relation. Each state-event pair is unique. All four states are reachable from draft, and every state has an outgoing path.

Transition register

A missing pair is rejected, leaving state and text unchanged. Do not invent an implicit transition because a button happens to look available.

STATE / EVENT / NEXT STATE

Success path

Draft → review → saved, using review then save-ok.

Recovery path

Review → error → review, using save-fail then retry.

Invalid input

Reject an unspecified pair without mutating text or state.

What happens when an event has no defined transition?

06 / INTERACTION CONTRACT

Treat input and a save result separately.

CONTRACT ROW

saved + edit → draft

MODEL BOUNDARY

4 states, 6 unique transitions; undefined pairs are rejected. Not implemented.



Figure 3 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

Editing a note changes text only in draft. Leaving saved through edit returns to draft before text changes. Review is an inspection state, not a second text editor.

A real save request would require validation and a defined pending state or request boundary. This simplified model deliberately starts at result events and must not be wired directly to a server without extension.

Input contract

No network request, live pending state or concurrency guarantee is supplied. Preserve that limitation when handing the model to implementation.

STATE / EVENT / NEXT STATE

Text rule

Apply body edits only while the note is in draft.

Result rule

Process save-ok or save-fail only while in review.

Extension

Define request and pending behavior before a real asynchronous save.

Which event represents user intent and which represents a result?

07 / INTERACTION CONTRACT

Explain feedback without overstating persistence.

CONTRACT ROW

draft + review → review

MODEL BOUNDARY

4 states, 6 unique transitions; undefined pairs are rejected. Not implemented.



Figure 4 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

A saved message must follow the implementation's confirmed storage outcome, not merely a click. An error message should preserve the author's text and explain a bounded next action.

The model can verify that error permits retry and that retry returns to review. It cannot establish data durability, storage quota, recovery after a crash or synchronization across devices.

Feedback semantics

A future implementation must name what was actually saved and where. Avoid a universal success message when only a temporary local buffer exists.

STATE / EVENT / NEXT STATE

Saved

Requires a confirmed implementation result outside this model.

Error

Keep the body available and explain retry without data-loss promises.

Boundary

No durability, cloud sync or cross-device behavior is verified.

What evidence permits the word saved?

08 / INTERACTION CONTRACT

Reject an invalid event predictably.

CONTRACT ROW

review + edit → draft

MODEL BOUNDARY

4 states, 6 unique transitions; undefined pairs are rejected. Not implemented.



Figure 4 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

Sending retry in draft is not defined. The modeled reducer rejects that pair and keeps the original state. Likewise, save-ok in error cannot leap directly to saved.

This keeps recovery visible: error must return to review through retry before a new result event is considered. An implementation still needs to decide how impossible or stale events are logged without exposing private text.

Exception handling

A stale callback is not automatically valid because its result once belonged to a request. The simplified model has no request IDs; concurrency needs a larger contract.

STATE / EVENT / NEXT STATE

Example

Draft plus retry is rejected with draft unchanged.

Example

Error plus save-ok is rejected with error unchanged.

Open

Request identity and stale-result handling are not yet specified.

Could an out-of-order result overwrite a newer edit?

09 / INTERACTION CONTRACT

Review usability as an open question.

CONTRACT ROW

review + save-ok → saved

MODEL BOUNDARY

4 states, 6 unique transitions; undefined pairs are rejected. Not implemented.



Figure 5 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

A model can be deterministic and still be hard to understand. Ask whether the review step is useful, whether state wording is clear and whether error recovery is discoverable.

Any future evaluation needs a working artifact, task boundaries and an appropriate participation process. Do not describe graph reachability as proof of usability or accessibility.

Evaluation questions

Keyboard, focus, announcements and error comprehension require implementation-specific testing. This document records requirements and questions, not a conformance result.

STATE / EVENT / NEXT STATE

Comprehension

Can a person distinguish review from a successful save?

Recovery

Can the person explain what retry preserves and changes?

Access

Keyboard and assistive-technology behavior remain unverified.

What should a future task reveal about the state labels?

10 / INTERACTION CONTRACT

Check the contract before handing it over.

CONTRACT ROW

review + save-fail → error

MODEL BOUNDARY

4 states, 6 unique transitions; undefined pairs are rejected. Not implemented.



Figure 5 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

The source register must contain exactly six unique state-event pairs, valid endpoints and four reachable states. The reducer rejects every pair outside that relation without mutation.

A walkthrough trace reaches saved through review and returns through edit. A second trace enters error, retries and then reaches saved. These are model checks, not executed product journeys.

Specification review

Keep the register, reducer assumptions and exclusions together. Adding a pending state requires revised tests and prose, not just a new badge.

STATE / EVENT / NEXT STATE

Checks

Unique pairs, known states, reachability and rejection behavior.

Trace

Draft, review, error, review, saved is a valid modeled sequence.

Handoff

No shipped editor, live save or usability validation is claimed.

What would invalidate the current specification?